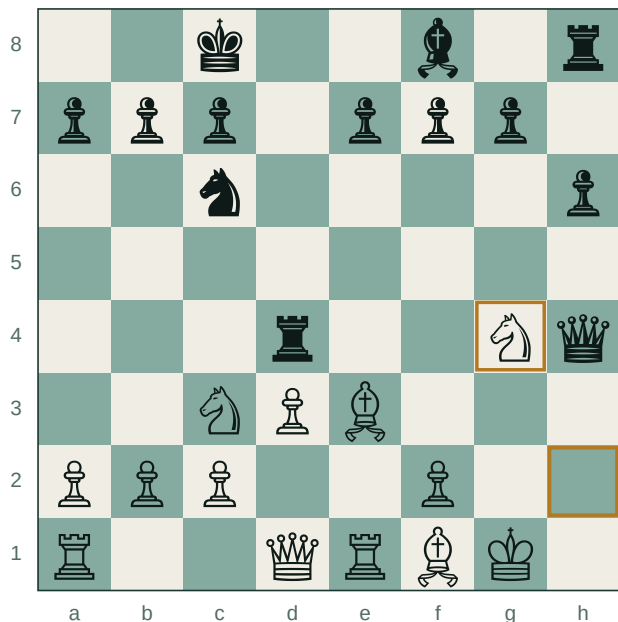


Pins and pressure: Black, move 14

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 14.Nxg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14...Rxg4+ 15. Bg2 Qh3 16. Qxg4+ Qxg4

14...Rxg4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on g4. Recorded reply: **15.Bg2.**

15...Qh3 The queen moves from h4 to h3. From h3 it attacks bishop on g2 and bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **16.Qxg4+.**

16...Qxg4 The queen captures the queen on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 27 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -4 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.